

MOHAMMAD ZARE

Academic Curriculum Vitae · Literary Studies / Translation Studies

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Research Profile

Literary researcher and interdisciplinary practitioner working across modern Persian literature, translation, born-digital writing, and the infrastructures through which texts are selected, framed, circulated, and read. I hold an MA in Dramatic Literature from the University of Art, Tehran (cumulative GPA 19.1/20) and a BSc in Industrial Engineering from Sharif University of Technology. My work combines close reading and comparative literary theory with corpus-building, interface design, qualitative user research from product work, and structured data analysis. Current creative and research work includes Persian research poetry, born-digital hypergraph poetry, generative literature, and a provenance-aware literary archive. Native Persian speaker; TOEFL iBT 106.

Research interests: world literature; translation studies; digital and periodical media; literary infrastructures and literary labor; modern Persian literature and theatre; born-digital literature; genetic criticism; minor literature; paratext and corpus research.

Education

MA in Dramatic Literature — University of Art, Tehran | 2020–2024 | GPA 19.1/20

Faculty of Cinema & Theatre · Supervisor: Kamran Sepehran

Thesis: “Study on Ugliness in the Plays of Abbas Nalbandian Based on the Concept of Minor Literature in the Views of Gilles Deleuze and Félix Guattari.”

Practical component: Grave (Goor), an original play developed as the practical counterpart of the thesis. The research treated ugliness through operations including the grotesque, fragmentation, formlessness, deterritorialization, political immediacy, and collective enunciation.

BSc in Industrial Engineering — Sharif University of Technology | 2015–2020

Coursework included operations research, engineering statistics, probability, linear algebra, data mining, information systems, production planning, project management, and product development.

Publications, Translation & Critical Writing

- **Zare, Mohammad.** “Bodies of Flight: An Essay on the Types and Connections of the Bodies of Sadegh Hedayat, Abbas Nalbandian, and Bahram Sadeghi.” In Persian. Nahib Interdisciplinary Quarterly, Issue 8: The Relation of Art and the Body, 2022. Comparative critical essay on bodies, constraint, decay, and lines of flight across three Persian modernist writers.
- **Hirsh, Sharon Latchaw.** “Sketches for Ferdinand Hodler’s Communion with Infinity.” Persian translation by **Mohammad Zare**. In Margdasht: Ferdinand Hodler and Valentine Godé-Darel, ed. S. S. Mousavi Khalkhali. Shahriaran Publication, Tehran, 2022. Translation required following a genetic-critical argument through preparatory sketches and changes in the work’s formation.

Selected Research-Creation, Digital Literature & Scholarly Projects

- **Ten Research Poems** — completed Persian research-poetry collection (manuscript, 34 pp.) containing ten poem sequences, source material, and a bibliography. The collection treats documentary research as visible material in relation to poetic writing. English translation is in progress with poet and translator Ali Asadollahi.
- **The Black Bird (v1.0.0, 2026)** — Born-digital hypergraph research poem in which research notes, poetic passages, multilingual names, source traces, and reader movement remain separately addressable; traversal order becomes part of the literary form. Its research annex computes speculative indices from the poem’s hypergraph (incidence and overlap matrices, with the data as CSV and JSON). Online: poem.theblackbirdfield.com.
- **Grave-Machine (v1.1.1, 2026)** — Generative electronic poem developed from the play Grave through the remix lineage of Nick Montfort’s Taroko Gorge; investigates what survives when dramatic material is transformed into

lexical banks, procedural rules, timing, recurrence, and generated poetic surface. Online:

theblackbirdfield.com/works/grave-machine.

- **Taroko Gorge Ecosystem Archive (v2.0.0, 2026)** — Python-based collection/reconciliation pipeline and query index for Taroko Gorge remixes; distinguishes works and records paratextual materials such as editorial statements, author statements, and biographies rather than collapsing them into one metadata layer. Online: github.com/mozareeduge/Taroko-Gorge-Ecosystem.
- **TAROKO REMIXER (authoring tool, v1.0.4, 2026)** — No-code authoring environment for generative poems in the Taroko Gorge lineage. Taroko Gorge's short, readable code let people without programming experience make their own versions by changing words and rules; TAROKO REMIXER extends that openness by turning lexical banks, rules and timing into configurable modules, so that a new generative poem can be built and exported as standalone HTML without writing code. Online: taroke-remixer.theblackbirdfield.com.

Curatorial, Editorial & Collective Practice

- **Story Officer, Factory Artistic Community** | Dec 2021–present
Writes and develops conceptual frameworks for collaborative exhibition and artist-book projects; works closely with artists on how objects, texts, materials, and exhibition frames organize interpretation.
- **Tāšitan Tēš (First Cavity), Shavadoon Art Gallery, Shoushtar** | May 2024
Conceptual framework for Hossein Shoorab's installation/drawing project on subterranean digging culture, water networks, tools, and material infrastructures.
- **Leakage, Cafe Farsh Gallery** | Jan 2024
Conceptual framework for a project on non-human intervention in closed systems and the displacement of human authorship.
- **Seventy Something, Shahriaran Gallery** | Jun 2022
Co-developed the exhibition framework and wrote its English statement; approached artistic work through the rules and contracts that organize social, scientific, and aesthetic fields.
- **Owraagh, Factory / Bon-gah Art Book Fair** | Jan 2022
Curatorial/framework text for an artist-book project treating page, sequence, dismantling, and recomposition as operations of the reading interface.
- **Co-founder & Director, Cultural Unit, Dad Magazine — Sharif University of Technology** | Apr 2017–Apr 2019
Co-founded and directed a cultural unit within a university magazine, providing early experience of editorial coordination and cultural production inside an engineering institution.

Professional Experience

Product Lead / Product Manager — ZarinPal | Jul 2024–present

- Leads product and system design for financial and open-banking services, translating complex backend constraints and workflows into user-facing products.
- Coordinates product, data, engineering, operations, and external integrations; works with structured data models, APIs, automation, and interface architecture.

Product Manager — Payman & Didar (B2B SaaS) | Feb 2022–Jul 2024

- Designed reporting, data-visualization, and multi-service integration capabilities.
- Used continuous discovery and iterative testing, combining qualitative user research with quantitative system data to test product hypotheses.

Product Analyst — Digikala | Apr 2021–Jan 2022

- Analyzed large-scale user and operational data to identify bottlenecks and support redesign of platform processes and user experience.

Teaching & Additional Practice

Art Teacher — Khatam High School | Jan–Jun 2022

Methods & Technical Practice

Close reading; comparative literary analysis; qualitative research and interviewing in product contexts; corpus reconciliation; paratext and source modeling; Python-based text/data pipelines; structured metadata and knowledge graphs; API and data-model literacy; interface prototyping; research-through-design; curatorial research and conceptual framing.

Languages

Persian	Native
English	Academic / professional proficiency — TOEFL iBT 106 (Reading 30, Listening 29, Speaking 22, Writing 25; Dec 2025)